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FIRST SEMESTER M.Tech EXAMINATION, JANUARY - 2025

IDEATION, CREATIVITY AND INNOVATION FOR STARTUPS

Time: 3 Hours **Maximum Marks: 100**

Instructions:
i. Answer **FIVE** full Questions. Question number 1 and 2 are compulsory. Each question carries 20 marks.
ii. Missing data may be suitably assumed.

			CO's	Blooms Level	Marks
1.	**a.**	A local coffee shop owner wants to introduce new related offerings and innovative service to improve customer experience. Analyze various options available to innovate in terms of their products, processes or services.	1	4	**20**
	b.	Illustrate how does an entrepreneur's orientation towards proactivity, innovation, and risk-taking influence their ability to identify new opportunities and drive business success in a competitive market?	1	3	
2.	**a.**	Entrepreneurs initiatives towards effective collaboration with partners, teams, and stakeholders to drive innovation and achieve long-term business success. Analyze the statement relating with effectuation approach.	2	4	**20**
	b.	John is a tech enthusiast with a passion for drones. He wants to start a business offering drone photography services but doesn't know how to proceed without a structured plan. Assess the effectuation principles that John can use in the case.	2	5	
3.	**a.**	Illustrate how can an agricultural startup use AI and IoT to come up with effective solutions for improved crop management and increased yields.	3	3	**20**
	b.	Examine the key environmental trends that are shaping consumer behavior and creating new business opportunities. How can startups leverage these trends to position themselves for success in the market?	3	4	
		OR			
4.	**a.**	Analyze the essential components of a startup feasibility analysis to assess the potential success of a new venture.	3	4	**20**
	b.	Select a business idea that you are passionate about. Develop a step-by-step plan for turning this idea into a successful business, focusing on the importance of conducting environmental impact assessments, evaluating the feasibility of the product or service, and performing early validation to ensure market readiness.	3	6	
5.	**a.**	A startup has developed an innovative wearable fitness tracker, but despite high initial interest, the product fails to gain significant traction in the market. Customer feedback reveals issues with its functionality and pricing, leading to poor sales. Analyze the reasons behind frequent failures of such innovative ideas in the	4	4	**20**

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		market, suggesting strategies to get better market acceptance.			
	b.	Explain bootstrapping and other funding methods available for startups. How entrepreneurs can choose the right option considering their unique circumstances and growth trajectory.	4	2	
		OR			
6.	**a.**	A mobile payment startup is aiming to introduce a digital payment solution in rural India, where cash is still the dominant mode of transaction. Despite the potential for financial inclusion, the startup faces challenges in convincing rural consumers to adopt digital payments due to limited access to smartphones, low financial literacy, and resistance to change. **Question:** Examine the strategies which can be adopted by the startup to overcome the barriers of smartphone access, financial literacy, and resistance to digital payment adoption in rural India?	4	4	**20**
	b.	A food-tech startup is trying to enter the competitive market of Bangalore with a new platform that connects local farmers directly with consumers to provide fresh, organic produce. **Question:** Appraise the appropriate marketing and funding strategies the startup should adopt to gain traction in Bangalore's competitive food market. What type of team members should they start with?	4	5	
7.	**a.**	A group of engineering students at a university is planning to launch a campus-based startup that provides affordable, 3D-printed prototypes for local small businesses. Despite the enthusiasm and technical expertise, they are facing challenges in securing initial funding, attracting customers, and managing time between academics and the startup. **Question:** Appraise various strategies that the engineering students can implement to overcome the challenges of securing funding, balancing academics with their startup, and building a customer base for their 3D printing service? How can they leverage their university network and resources to gain traction and credibility in the market?	5	5	**20**
	b.	Develop a business model canvas based on any idea of yours (preferably related to your campus, or your residential place). Highlight your value proposition, customers, channels, cost and revenue structure and key operational activities amongst others.	**5**	**6**	
		OR			
8.	**a.**	Select any startup business idea from past (prefer a failed idea) and design a plan for relaunch of the same. Make major changes in the revamped business model making assumptions wherever required.	**5**	**6**	
	b.	A group of MTech students is developing a new mobile app aimed at improving campus event management. Develop an action plan for them from initial idea development to market entry.	**5**	**6**	